

Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

July 2, 2024

Sent Via Electronic Mail

Ed Schmidt
Tres Pinos County Water District
Tres Pinos County Water District Wastewater Treatment Plant
P.O. BOX #1001
Tres Pinos, CA, 95075
Email: edschmidt880@yahoo.com

Dear Ed Schmidt,

**TRES PINOS COUNTY WATER DISTRICT WASTEWATER TREATMENT PLANT,
BEHIND 8223 SOUTHSIDE ROAD, TRES PINOS, SAN BENITO COUNTY:
TRANSMITTAL OF MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM R3-2024-0044
REVISING MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM R3-2022-0078**

Please find the **revised** monitoring and reporting program R3-2024-0044 (Attachment 1). The revised monitoring and reporting program applies to the monitoring and reporting requirements for the Tres Pinos County Water District's Wastewater Treatment Plant (WWTP), owned and operated by the Tres Pinos County Water District, and regulated by *Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ, General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems Less than 100,000 Gallons Per Day* (General Permit). This revised monitoring and reporting program is effective immediately, and supersedes and replaces all previous versions of the monitoring and reporting program required by your enrollment in the General Permit.

This revised monitoring and reporting program makes the following change:

Reduction of the frequency for pond freeboard monitoring from daily to weekly. Tres Pinos County Water District has provided sufficient data to determine that for the 2023 year, there were no significant changes to average daily freeboard variation to continue to warrant daily monitoring. A reduction in daily freeboard monitoring will decrease the onsite labor hours which will translate to cost savings for the District.

If you have any questions, please contact **Mark Lemus at (805) 549-3703 or by email at Mark.Lemus@Waterboards.ca.gov**, or Jennifer Epp at Jennifer.Epp@waterboards.ca.gov.

Sincerely,

Jennifer Epp Digitally signed by Jennifer Epp
Date: 2024.07.01 16:33:32
-07'00'
Water Boards

for Ryan E. Lodge
Executive Officer

Attachments:

Attachment 1: Monitoring and Reporting Program No. R3-2024-0044

cc:

Maria Fehl, trespinoswaterdistrict@gmail.com
Alan Bracewell, alan@bracewellengineering.com
Mark Lemus, Mark.Lemus@Waterboards.ca.gov
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Jennifer Epp, Jennifer.Epp@Waterboards.ca.gov
WDR Program, RB3-WDR@Waterboards.ca.gov GeoTracker

ECM/CIWQS = CW-266350

GeoTracker No. = GT- WDR100036960

Rev 10/7/22

Subject Name = Tres Pinos Revised MRP

**CALIFORNIA REGIONAL WATER QUALITY CONTROL BOARD
CENTRAL COAST REGION**

MONITORING AND REPORTING PROGRAM NO. R3-2024-0044

for

**TRES PINOS COUNTY WATER DISTRICT WASTEWATER TREATMENT PLANT
SAN BENITO COUNTY**

This monitoring and reporting program describes requirements for monitoring a wastewater treatment system for Tres Pinos County Water District located Behind 8223 Southside Road in Tres Pinos, CA, 95075.

Tres Pinos County Water District owns and operates the wastewater system that is subject to the notice of applicability dated December 23, 2022, for coverage in *Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ, General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems* (General Permit).

1. SAMPLING AND ANALYSIS

All samples must be representative of the volume and nature of the discharge or matrix of materials sampled. The name of the sampler, sample type (grab or composite), time, date, location, bottle type, and any preservative used for each sample shall be recorded on the sample chain of custody form. The chain of custody form must also contain all custody information including date, time, and to whom the samples were relinquished. If composite samples are collected, the basis for sampling (time or flow weighted) shall be approved by the Central Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Central Coast Water Board). Unless otherwise specified below, sampling shall be performed as shown in Table 1.

Table 1. Sampling and Monitoring Schedule

Monitoring Period	Sample Collection Months
Annually	October
Semiannually	April and October
Quarterly	January, April, July, and October
Monthly	Each month of the year

Field test instruments (such as those to test pH, dissolved oxygen, and electrical conductivity) may be used provided that they are used by a State Water Resources Control Board (State Water Board) California Environmental Laboratory Accreditation Program certified laboratory, or:

1. The user is trained in proper use and maintenance of the instruments;

2. The instruments are field calibrated prior to monitoring events at the frequency recommended by the manufacturer;
3. Instruments are serviced and/or calibrated by the manufacturer at the recommended frequency; and
4. Field calibration reports are maintained and available for at least three years.

2. WATER SUPPLY MONITORING

Representative samples of the water supply must be collected and analyzed as shown in Table 2 from the production wells prior to any disinfection.

In lieu of the required water supply sampling, Tres Pinos County Water District may request approval to submit a Well Identification Number and the reporting year's consumer confidence report (annual water quality report or drinking water quality report), as required by the State Water Board Division of Drinking Water and/or county. Tres Pinos County Water District must report the results of any constituent monitored more frequently than is required by this monitoring and reporting program. Tres Pinos County Water District must also report detectable concentrations (above the reporting limit) for any other constituent that has a published maximum contaminant level (MCL).

Table 2. Water Supply Monitoring

Parameter	Units	Type of Sample	Sampling and Reporting Frequency
TDS ¹	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Nitrate (as N)	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Calcium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Magnesium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Sodium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Potassium	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Chloride	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Sulphate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Carbonate	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Boron	mg/L	Grab	Annually
Fluoride	mg/L	Grab	Annually

mg/L = milligrams per liter

[1] Measured not calculated.

3. MONITORING LOCATIONS

Monitoring location information, including nomenclature that shall be used when reporting data to the GeoTracker database (described below), is shown in Table 3.

Table 3. Monitoring Locations

Sample Title	GeoTracker Field Point Code	Sample Description
Influent Sample – 1	IS-1	Representative grab sample at influent pump station.
Effluent Sample – 1	ES-1	Representative grab sample from Pond 2 effluent pipeline before effluent storage tank

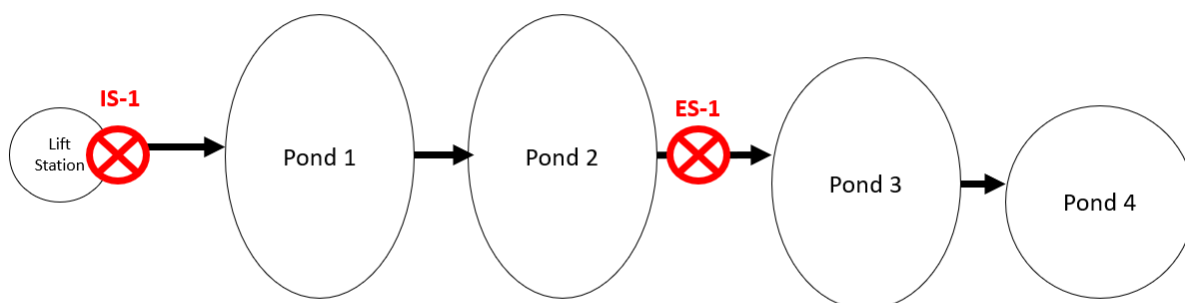


Figure 1. Process Flow Diagram with Sampling Locations

4. POND TREATMENT UNIT MONITORING

4.1 Flow Monitoring

Tres Pinos County Water District must monitor and report flow, as described in Table 4, with each monitoring report.

Table 4. Flow Monitoring

Parameter	Units	Sample Type	Sampling Frequency
Daily Flow	Gallons per day	Metered	Daily
Maximum Daily Flow	Gallons per day	Metered	Monthly
Mean Daily Flow	Gallons per day	Calculated	Monthly

1.2 Influent and Effluent Constituent Monitoring

Representative samples of Tres Pinos County Water District Wastewater Treatment Plant's influent (raw wastewater) into the wastewater system and effluent (treated wastewater) discharged to land must be collected and analyzed as follows. All samples must be grab.

Table 5. Influent and Effluent Monitoring

Parameter/ Constituent	Units	INFLUENT (IS-1) Sampling Frequency	EFFLUENT (ES-1) Sampling Frequency
Biochemical Oxygen Demand, 5-Day	mg/L	Quarterly	Monthly
Total Suspended Solids	mg/L	Quarterly	Monthly
pH	pH units	Quarterly	Monthly
Total Nitrogen	mg/L	Quarterly	Monthly
Nitrate (as N) + Nitrite (as N) or separate species ¹	mg/L	Quarterly	Monthly
Total Kjeldahl Nitrogen (as N)	mg/L	Quarterly	Monthly
Total Dissolved Solids ²	mg/L	Quarterly	Monthly
Calcium	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually
Magnesium	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually
Sodium	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually
Potassium	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually
Chloride	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually
Sulphate	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually
Bicarbonate	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually
Carbonate	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually
Boron	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually
Fluoride	mg/L	Semiannually	Semiannually

mg/L = milligram per liter

[1] Nitrate and nitrite sample may be combined

[2] Measured not calculated

1.3 WASTEWATER POND MONITORING

All wastewater ponds and storage ponds must be monitored consistent with Table 6. Tres Pinos Water District must inspect the ponds weekly and notations must be made in a bound logbook and include "observations" of the items in Table 6. Any problems

must be promptly corrected and recorded. The bound logbook of these observations must be maintained onsite and made available to the Central Coast Water Board upon inspection. Only violations and mitigation measures must be included in the subsequent monitoring report.

Table 6. Wastewater Pond Monitoring

Parameter	Units	Sample Type	Sample Frequency
Dissolved Oxygen	mg/L	Grab ²	Weekly
pH	Std. units	Grab ²	Weekly
Evaporation	Inches	Weather station ³	Daily
Freeboard	0.1 feet	Measurement	Weekly
Odors	--	Observation	Weekly
Berm Condition	--	Observation	Weekly
Plant Growth	--	Observation	Weekly
Vectors or Animals Burrowing	--	Observation	Weekly

mg/L = milligrams per liter

[2] Grab samples can be collected via handheld probe, see section 1 of this MRP

[3] Weather station may be site-specific station, onsite evaporation pan, or nearby governmental weather reporting station

5. SOLIDS DISPOSAL MONITORING

Tres Pinos County Water District must report the handling and disposal of all solids (e.g., screenings, grit, sludge, biosolids, grease, etc.) generated at the wastewater treatment system. Records must include the name/contact information for the hauling company, the type and amount of waste transported, the date removed from the wastewater system, the disposal facility name and address, and copies of analytical data required by the entity accepting the waste. These records must be submitted as part of the subsequent monitoring report.

6. COLLECTION SYSTEM MAINTENANCE

Tres Pinos County Water District must submit records of any maintenance performed on the sewer collection system within the past year.

7. REPORTING

The semiannual monitoring reports must be submitted in accordance with Table 7.

Table 7. Semiannual Monitoring Reports

Report	Monitoring Period	Report Due Date
First Semiannual Report	January 1 to June 30	August 1
Second Semiannual Report	July 1 to December 31	February 1

At a minimum, the semiannual reports must include:

- **Facility Information and Description** -- Briefly describe your facility, treatment process, and disposal process with references to figures.
- **Data Tables** -- Tabular summaries of all monitoring data (water supply, influent, effluent, and groundwater) compared to effluent limits, as appropriate. Submit the results of any pollutant or parameter monitored more frequently than is required by this monitoring program.
- **Compliance and Performance Discussion** --
 - Disclosure of any noncompliance (violations) with of the notice of applicability and/or General Permit requirements, including a description, it's cause, the exact date(s) and time(s), and the steps taken or planned to reduce, eliminate and prevent recurrence of the noncompliance.
 - An evaluation (graphs recommended) of the treatment facilities' performance, including percent removal of the main pollutants (BOD₅, TSS, Total Nitrogen) over time, nuisance conditions, system problems, etc.
 - A discussion of any data gaps and potential deficiencies in the monitoring system or reporting program.
- **Disposal Area Inspection** -- Report the results of the disposal area inspections, as described in Section 6.
- **Solids Disposal** -- If solids are disposed of offsite, comply with the reporting in Section 7.
- **Operator Information** -- List the name and contact information for the wastewater operators responsible for operation, maintenance, and/or system monitoring.
- **Flow Evaluation** -- A summary in tabular format of the maximum and average flows for each month and comparison to permitted flows.
- **Figures** -- A wastewater treatment process flow diagram with a label for the monitoring locations and a scaled facility map showing the treatment system, discharge points, and wells (supply and groundwater, if present).
- **Laboratory Sheets** -- Copies of laboratory analytical report(s) and chain of custody form(s).

8. ELECTRONIC SUBMITTAL

All monitoring reports must be provided electronically in a searchable PDF format, with the Central Coast Water Board's current transmittal sheet found at the link below as the cover page. The transmittal sheet must be signed.

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/centralcoast/water_issues/programs/wastewater_permiiting/docs/transmittal_sheet.pdf

Tres Pinos County Water District Wastewater Treatment Plant must submit all reports/documents and laboratory analytical data (influent, effluent, groundwater data) to the State Water Board's GeoTracker^{1,2} database consistent with applicable Electronic Submittal of Information (ESI) requirements under a wastewater system-specific global identification number **WDR100036960** at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/esi/login>

Table 8 summarizes the GeoTracker electronic reporting requirements. For general questions, please contact the GeoTracker Help Desk: Geotracker@waterboards.ca.gov.

Table 8. GeoTracker Electronic Submittal Information (ESI) Data Requirements

Electronic Submittal	Description of Action	Action	Frequency
Reports and Documents	Complete copy of all documents including monitoring reports (in searchable PDF format) and any other associated documents related to the Wastewater System.	Upload directly to GeoTracker all monitoring reports (in searchable PDF format) and any other associated documents.	On or before the due dates required by this General Permit and for other documents when required by the Central Coast Water Board.
Laboratory Data	All analytical data (including geochemical data) in electronic deliverable format (EDF). This includes all water, soil, and vapor samples collected when monitoring a discharge.	Upload, or direct your State Certified Laboratory staff to upload, all laboratory data directly to GeoTracker.	On or before the due date of the required monitoring report

¹ Information for first-time GeoTracker users is available at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/ust/electronic_submittal/docs/beginnerguide2.pdf

² Additional information available at:

<https://geotracker.waterboards.ca.gov/>

Electronic Submittal	Description of Action	Action	Frequency
Depth to Groundwater	Monitoring wells must have the depth-to-water information reported. Report data only for wells defined as permanent sampling points.	Upload depth-to-water information to the GeoTracker GEO_WELL file.	On or before the due date of the required monitoring report
Boring Logs and Well Screen Intervals	Boring logs must be prepared by a registered professional and submitted in PDF format separately (not only as attachments to reports)	Upload boring logs (in searchable PDF format) to GeoTracker whenever a new boring is drilled.	Every time a new boring is drilled.
Location data (Geo XY)	Name, classify, and identify the location (latitude and longitude) of all sampling points. Monitoring wells must be surveyed, influent and effluent sample locations must be identified on the GeoTracker mapping tool under “non-surveyed data.”	Upload the location data (surveyed and non-surveyed) to the GeoTracker Geo_XY file.	These data points are required prior to laboratory data uploads. Must be added every time a permanent monitoring point is established.
Elevation Data (Geo Z)	Mark the elevation at the top of groundwater well casings for all permanent groundwater wells. These points are required prior to depth-to-water data uploads.	Upload the survey data to the GeoTracker GEO_Z File.	One-time, for all groundwater monitoring wells.
Geo Map	Site layout, map of facilities, wastewater treatment system, and disposal area(s).	Upload the Site layout PDF to the GeoTracker site plan file.	One time, or when the facility is modified.

9. TECHNICAL REPORTS

Tres Pinos County Water District must submit to GeoTracker the reports described in General Permit *Section E. 1. Technical Report Preparation Requirements* by the dates included in Table 9. If this information is already contained in an operation and maintenance manual or similar document, that may be submitted in compliance with this

requirement.

9.1 DISPOSAL POND MAINTENANCE PLAN

The wastewater treatment plant was not designed with the flexibility to alternate percolation pond usage. The decline in pond percolation performance has created some concerns with overall wastewater plant capacity in the past. The current practice is to scrape the bed of the pond with heavy equipment while the pond still has standing water, this restores some percolation to the pond however it does not allow for full recovery of the percolation rates. Tres Pinos County Water District must submit a Disposal Pond Maintenance Plan for Central Coast Water Board approval to include the following at a minimum:

1. Determination of the frequency of pond maintenance to occur via establishing a threshold for action based off incoming flow and percolation/evaporation rates. These numbers should be provided with the semiannual self monitoring reports.
2. Developing a short and long term solution to modify the current flow scheme to allow for full sequestration of a disposal pond for a completely dry pond maintenance.
3. An analysis of the pond bed soil column (sieve analysis, hydraulic conductivity, and other appropriate soil permeability tests) to determine if the pond should be ripped/disked or if a layer of the pond bedding should be removed and replaced with appropriate soil to restore adequate percolation rates.
4. A project timeline for work to be completed to restore pond percolation rates.

Table 9. Technical Report Submittal Due Dates

Report	Report Due Date
Spill Prevention & Emergency Response Plan	March 23, 2023
Sampling and Analysis Plan	March 23, 2023
Sludge Management Plan	March 23, 2023
Disposal Pond Maintenance Plan	March 23, 2023

Note: the report due dates are unchanged from the previous monitoring and reporting program R3-2022-0078

10. LEGAL REQUIREMENTS

The Central Coast Water Board's requirements that Tres Pinos County Water District submit the technical and monitoring reports described in this monitoring and reporting program are made pursuant to [section 13267 of the California Water Code](#). Failure to submit reports in accordance with schedules established by this General Permit and notice of applicability with attachments or failure to submit a report of sufficient technical

quality to be acceptable to the Central Coast Water Board may subject Tres Pinos County Water District to enforcement action pursuant to [section 13268 of the California Water Code](#).

The Central Coast Water Board needs the required information to ensure compliance with the notice of applicability and the General Permit. Tres Pinos County Water District is required to submit this information because it is subject to the General Permit and is responsible for the discharge.

The burden, including costs, of the reports bears a reasonable relationship to their need and the benefits to be obtained. The requirement for the reports is necessary to ensure compliance with the General Permit, notice of applicability, and monitoring and reporting program to protect water quality.

Tres Pinos County Water District must implement the above monitoring program on July 2, 2024. The Central Coast Water Board may rescind or modify the monitoring and reporting program at any time. Tres Pinos County Water District must not implement any changes to this monitoring and reporting program unless and until a revised monitoring and reporting program is issued by the Central Coast Water Board.

Ordered by:

 Digitally signed by Jennifer
Epp
Date: 2024.07.01 16:34:05
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Water Boards

for Ryan E. Lodge
Executive Officer